

Exposure

As the term 'photography' suggests, light is the soul of your photograph. But be it digital or film photography, with too much light the picture will appear washed out and with too little light the picture appears dark and muddy. Exposure is the measure of the amount of light used to create a photo, and that's exactly what makes a good photograph.



INFO

There are three measures of exposure—'underexposure' where the amount of light available or used for capturing the photo is insufficient resulting in darkened photos. The second type is 'overexposure' where there is excess light casting a white tint over the entire photograph making it appear too bright. The final is 'correct exposure' where shadow and highlight areas are correctly visible.

Most digital cameras use auto exposure to set the appropriate level of light required for a shot. All you need to do is press the shutter button half way down and let the camera take a few seconds to adjust the aperture and shutter speed. However, it is not always recommended to shoot on the recommended exposure levels. Try to adjust the exposure levels manually to get your desired level of brightness on the end result.



White Balance

White balance is used by digital cameras to keep the colours looking as natural as possible in the picture. To do so, the camera analyses the scene to determine which area is truly white and adjusts itself to the rest of the scene accordingly. If the level of one colour (eg. red) appears too high on the white part, the camera will automatically adjust itself to remove the same level of red from the rest

of the picture to make it appear more natural.

Though most cameras do a pretty good job of adjusting the white balance, it is always a good idea to manually adjust the white balance in some lighting situations. For example, when a room is